



Atlantic Association of Geomatics and Planning

Annual General Meeting

October 8, 2025

Online

Meeting Called to Order

AAGP President Tyler Veinot called the meeting to order at 12:05 p.m.

In Attendance

Tyler Veinot, President

Tippy Scott, Vice President

Holly Sanford, Treasurer

Mitchell Logie, Secretary & Nova Scotia Provincial Representative

Maggie Pitts, Media Relations Officer

Paul Edgar, New Brunswick Provincial Representative

Adam Holmes

Melissa Deveau

Nick White

Sanket Jotania

Regrets

Approval of Agenda

It was moved by Tippy Scott and seconded by Paul Edgar to approve the agenda for the 2025 AAGP Annual General Meeting.

Motion Carried

Minutes of Last Annual General Meeting

It was moved by Tippy Scott and seconded by Paul Edgar to approve the September 24th, 2024 Annual General Meeting Minutes.

Motion Carried

Business Arising from Minutes

A) Future of the AAGP

- Tyler – Broadly, without an education committee it is hard to put on workshops. Tyler does not have a lot of time to put on a workshop. Tippy has put on three in a row and did a lot of the work the last time. Our treasurer, Holly, has moved into a new role and the association is not as relevant to this role change. Long and short, between the most recent workshop and 22 members who have not paid we are not in a position to host another workshop. Do we want to cut back on membership fees and continue as a list-server for the next while? Where are we at because this is not sustainable.
- Tippy: three avenues –
 - Base level: reduce / drop membership fees altogether so that it is just a list-server and serves as networking and we don't host any events.
 - Maybe we will be surprised and there might be a number of people who want to step up to executive or the education committee.
 - Dissolve altogether. Take the next while towards dissolving the association altogether.
- Adam Holmes: don't want to see AAGP dissolve but doesn't have the time to contribute like he did 10 years ago. Felt that the list-server might be the best option to keep things alive.
- Tippy: if we vote to dissolve today it takes a whole year to do this.
 - Returning membership fees and other logistics are going to take some time.
 - List-server: as far as Mitchell is aware the Government of Nova Scotia is not charging us for this. Could continue with this being how the AAGP exists moving forward. Membership would be open to anyone wanting to be part of the list-server.
 - Body: President, Vice-President, Secretary, Treasurer (if there was a cost aspect) or a board willing to manage the members of the list-server moving forward.
 - Tyler: is the running of the list-server a last resort to keep the association to hold us over until we get interest or just until we run out of money and aren't able to keep the lights on so to speak.
 - Assuming that since no one has rushed to their microphones, that we don't have anyone willing to take on a role on council or help with the education committee. It is fairly safe to say that we won't be able to move forward.
 - On top of Mitchell taking on three roles on council, he also joined the education committee this past year. Education Committee has not historically been three council members, it has been the Vice-President overseeing a group of 5 or more members.
 - Holly is also going to be looking to move away from the Treasurer role. This will make it hard for us to operate.
 - 10 people in this meeting, which leaves six (6) non-executives present. At least half of them would need to agree to be on the education committee.

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- Paul indicated willingness to look at taking the Treasurer role over if Holly is stepping down. Paul has offered to help with workshops in the past but does not want to lead necessarily.
 - Maggie: could we just pause the workshops. Do we continue with the website.
 - Website has a cost for hosting content and the cost of the website domain.
 - Only option for this would be to hand code the website and find a place to host the content for free. There would still be the cost of the domain in any case.
 - This either leaves us with completely dissolving or staying on as a list-server. Mitchell and Tippy offered to be part of a group to look after the list-server
 - If we say a motion to running as just a list-server, do we need to give fore warning to our members. No precedence for this because the by-laws were never written for the possibility of dissolution.
 - Nick White with Stantec in Newfoundland and Labrador has served on boards before. Felt it might be good to go back over what the purpose of the group is. Struggling to see how not having an education committee turns into not having finances and therefore we then shut things down. Tippy acknowledged that this is a fair point and asked Tyler to do some introductions.
 - Tyler: going back a long time ago to when COGS had a planning technician program, the then AAPT was created as a supporting resource for that discipline. Over time it expanded to workshops and socials (used to be 2 workshops a year but then that dropped down to one). Used to have someone who would update social media pages etc. Growing strong and had some decent memberships etc. Then covid hit and things just ground to a halt. Largely focused on helping and supporting Planning Technicians / GIS professionals in the Atlantic Provinces. Changed name to AAGP to expand the scope of the association and bring in more people interested from different corners of the GIS Industry. Tippy added that for the workshops they have declined in attendance and in terms of membership we have gotten some interest from students and there is still not an increase in participation. Also, since Covid we have only had people leave council / education committee and no one to step in with those roles. Other members of council then proceeded to introduce themselves.
 - Agreed to go over council reports and then circle back to the future of the AAGP discussion.
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 - Nick White felt that, and Tyler agreed, that it is not all doom and gloom at this point. The issue is that we are stagnated once more. There is a lot of potential, we just need new energy.
 - Tippy: There are ways that we can look at pairing things down. Do we just maintain a list-server and if there is an appetite to bring something up like a one-off webinar or something. We have for the last two AGMs tried to garner support for workshops and we may have to say goodbye to that until a new group of people want to jump up and participate. At this moment we aren't at the capacity to charge forward with another conference. Tippy is open to leaving this AGM with the direction to look into maintaining the list-server and potentially looking at our savings for potential reduction in membership fees for the time being moving forward.

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- Holly felt that Tippy's perspective was realistic – the conference could not happen next year because we do not have the capacity to make that happen.
- Tyler: it is the most practical thing unless and until things change. Best plan to pair back, run the list-server for a year, not get into planning anything too crazy.
- Tippy moved that following the AGM the executive looks at how the association may pair down its activities and / or look to dissolve. Not in any immediate financial issues even if we returned the membership fees that were paid we would still have enough to keep the website going for the next year.
- Paul: part of going with what Tippy is suggesting that the threat of dissolution could be a real possibility that might get people engaged or else the AAGP comes to its end.
- Tyler: leaving things open in case we get a sudden increase in participation that we could then fund something.
- Tippy revised the motion. Actually maybe we don't need a motion to say that we don't need a workshop. Tippy's thought was do we need a directive to look into what it means to just be a list-server or to dissolve and then bring that back to membership for a vote.
- Tyler noted that all of council are up for renewal next year and that he will not be re-offering next year so it would be good to have a plan for how to proceed when that happens.
- Rather than a motion, asking executive to look into what the AAGP could look like just as a list-server or to completely dissolve.
- Tippy moved that executive and council investigate what it would look like for the AAGP to function as a list-server or dissolve and then re-engage membership with our findings. Likely this would require an interim meeting or vote at the next AGM.
- Motion approved by Paul Edgar and seconded by Maggie Pitts.
- **Motion carried.**

Business Arising from Executive Minutes

No new business.

Correspondence

There was no correspondence at this year's annual general meeting.



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Financial Report

Treasurer Holly Sanford presented the 2024-2025 AAGP Financial Report with the report showing a balance of \$4588.18 as of September 30, 2025. \$3427.80 in the chequing account, \$ 1340.38 in the designated savings account.

Holly reviewed the costs for this year's conference and more money was allocated this year but this was planned for because of the 50th anniversary. Membership Fees and Conference costs go towards this.

Costs for Google Workspace costs went up as well. Things are increasing.

It was moved by Tippy Scott and seconded by Paul Edgar that the financial report be accepted.

Motion carried

Membership Report

Mitchell Logie presented the [2024 - 2025 AAGP Membership Report](#) on behalf of council with the association having 61 members of various levels as of October 8, 2025. We currently have at least one (1) member in each of the Atlantic Provinces and we also have one (1) member in Ontario.

Tippy noted that the 22 members who have been invoiced but not paid – this is a trend, not a new thing this year. Tyler highlighted that this impacts the financial piece and makes it hard to keep the workshops going etc.

It was moved by Tippy Scott and seconded by Paul Edgar that the membership report be accepted.

Motion carried

New Business

Holly willing to stay on as Treasurer until we figure out our new direction. Paul agreed that it would be good for a consistency basis. Once we have made that determination then we could move forward with a new financial person at that point. Holly would rather not commit to a whole other year but will stay on until things are figured out. Tippy felt it would be wise to nominate Paul to fill in after Holly has stepped down. Tippy nominated Paul for Treasurer and seconded by Holly. **Motion Carried.** Holly and Paul will work together on this.



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Education Committee

Tippy: Typically chaired by the Vice-President. We historically had groups of maybe four (4) or five (5) of people who are not part of council who get together in the fall to start planning for a conference in June. Historically planned for a 3 day conference but now it is a two-day conference. Presentations, lunches, dinners, events outside of the daily presentations, booking spaces, groups of hotels / hospitality suite (in the past, not in recent years). Also a few times have done webinars over the years. Also had a social the last couple of years (book a table see who turns out to get together and network etc.). 50th anniversary conference with theme of GeoAI was held this past June – despite low attendance it was successful. Had some new faces, asked people if anyone would be interested in helping out and it was sort of crickets.

Tyler: Traditionally, be anywhere from five (5) to eight (8) people and the only person from council would be the vice-president and their role was to take decisions back to council for things like budgeting approvals etc. Some of the things that dropped off was that in the past members contributed presentations and we've had to outsource a lot of presentations the last number of years which requires a lot of cold calls and the cost associated with that. Whereas before if half the presentations were members talking about what they are doing in their organizations / committees it was easier because we could work with them and maybe give them a discount or something. All of these little losses are adding up. Also, costs have gone up – the pricing model that we are running off of is post-covid and the last two years in a row we have raised prices and this may have been perceived as a shock to those who might have thought about coming.

Tippy: List-server is a good means of engagement but only a handful of people use it and most of those people are present in this meeting today.

Election of Provincial Representatives

Paul noted that one thing with Provincial Representatives is engaging with potential new members. Tyler noted that at one time Provincial Representatives had the biggest impact in terms things like workshop locations.

Elections of provincial representatives for the 2025/2026 year were held and results were as follows

Nova Scotia Representative – Mitchell Logie
Prince Edward Island Representative – Vacant
New Brunswick Representative – Paul Edgar
Newfoundland Representative – Nick White



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All positions were uncontested and were acclaimed except for the role of Provincial Representative for Provincial Representative for Prince Edward Island which both remained vacant at the conclusion of the Annual General Meeting.

Additional Business

Paul: Membership might be bigger if we had a certification in place (e.g. CET) but that would be quite onerous and involved. Ask those present how we can get people more involved.

Tyler: when COGS had the Planning Technician program, this was a membership requirement. Since those programs were dropped at several institutions (Holland College, etc.) we moved away from the hard-line position. There was never a hard certification that way. If anyone else has any ideas feel free to throw them out there we would love to hear them.

Nick: Going back to what is the vision / what we offer – it sounds like the conferences were a big deal. Be clear on the membership fees (don't underestimate the potential networking etc.). Resurgence in groups typically through social media for those who are anxious to get connected.

Tyler: have in the past gone to schools for industry expos at COGS. Tippy: Maggie runs our social media. Maggie: LinkedIn has picked up a bit – definitely a better place compared to Facebook. Focus more on LinkedIn than Facebook. Tippy: LinkedIn makes the most sense for our group because we are not creating content. We had something going with YouTube at one point.

Tyler: Webinars and social media are something we could explore at council meetings.

Tippy: I think we have had all these discussions in the past and we have worked at things like starting up LinkedIn and going to COGS and doing webinars for a year and adding the socials and after doing those for a few years now and not seeing interest in that not opposed to having those conversations again but ideally would need to see more invigoration in terms of participation / support. Maybe the loss of the conference would help people be willing to help with something like organizing a webinar etc.

Paul: Is there a place that we can put something like “what do you want to see for webinars” etc. Tippy: we did put out a survey at one point in time so maybe we need to revisit that. Paul offered to reach out to Moncton's Director of Asset Management (Engineering) and see if they would be willing to deliver a talk / webinar on that. Paul asked about maybe something on different tracking software's for something like subdivision plans etc. Tyler: if we can get that figured out in the next few weeks, we might be able to get that setup for a webinar to see how that pans out for engagement.

Adjournment

Meeting was adjourned at 1:37 pm